

Company: ISS-STOXX

Job Profile: Software Engineer

Offer Type: Internship + Placement

Internship Stipend: 60K

CTC: 12.9 Base + 1.1 (PF and Gratuity) = 14L + Variable bonus (not mentioned yet)

Location: Nesco IT Park, Goregaon, Mumbai

Process Date: 05-08-2025, Completely Offline

Background: Firstly, I would say that the placement process is unpredictable, chaotic and tiring. So never lose hope and give your 100% to each process. There is a huge factor of luck, but I would say instead of focusing on something that is not in your hands, put effort and time into sharpening your skills.

Before I got selected for ISS, I had faced rejections from interview rounds for summer internship at both Barclays and General Mills and then at JPMC and Nomura during this placement season. I was also the last one to be placed in my friend group, so DO NOT GIVE UP!!!!

Placement Process:

A total of 3 rounds were conducted - 1 Online Assessment Round, 1 Tech Interview Round & Finally, 1 HR Round. All were conducted on the same day, 5/08/25. The CGPA Criteria for SDE was 8.5, later reduced to 8. It was further reduced to 7.5. It may not be the case for next year if they don't want more applicants, so it is preferable to maintain a pointer of 8.5 and above

1. **Resume/CGPA Shortlisting:** [Approx 150-160 students]

Tailor your resume according to the JD of the company and your strong skills. Once your resume is finalised, evaluate its compatibility with ATS. Tools like Resume Worded can help and aim for a score of 65 or above. The shortlist of candidates selected for the Online Assessment and Pre-Placement Talk (PPT) was released on 3rd August 2025 at 7:00 PM.

2. Pre-Placement Talk:

The Pre-Placement Talk was conducted online on 4th August 2025 at 5:00 PM. The information shared during Pre-Placement Talks is extremely valuable, so it's important to be attentive — not just to the content of the presentation, but also to the names and roles of the presenters. I made it a point to take SS and jot down the specific examples used while the speaker explained some of the company's financial services. You can make use of all these points in the HR round and also while asking questions at the end of your interviews.

3. Online Assessment: (Approx. 160 students appeared, invigilated by the company)

The online assessment comprised 70 questions to be completed in 90 minutes. It was conducted via Google Forms at the college premises. +1 was given for each correct answer and -0.25 for incorrect ones. You were allowed to use the system calculator.

The assessment covered four major sections: Java, Python, SQL, and Aptitude. The Java and Python part was mostly output-based MCQs, with a prime focus on OOPS concepts, errors, exceptions, stack, queue and all types of sets in Java. The SQL part was relatively easy with just queries as an answer. The aptitude had a total of 30 questions, and it had all types of questions you could find on Indiabix. So I would suggest solving questions whose concepts are known to you.

4. Technical Round 1: [44 students appeared] 1 interviewer in my panel

I was the 2nd last person in my panel, and the panellist was the same who invigilated my classroom during the test. In the panel distribution list, the name of the panellist was given, so I had looked her up on LinkedIn (it helps to ask questions at the end of the interview). My panellist was very careful and also cheerful while taking the interviews, as I gave my interview at 6:30 in the evening when many students had already given their HR round and had gone home. So do not panic and get stressed the whole time ur sitting outside TPO.

The interview started by asking my name and how my test was. I explained that I solved most of the Java and Python part, but the aptitude was a little lengthy. No introduction was asked to me. Then she asked me what I had prepared for the interview, and I said that I had prepared DBMS, OS, SQL, OOPS, JAVA. Be careful what you say in this part, as they will ask in depth about these topics. She asked me briefly about my first project and then started asking SQL queries. The first question was about giving the maximum salary in each dept, and then followed by a query for the top 2 salaries in each dept. I had to write the query on paper. Then she added a gender and city column to the same table and told me to give names of female employees who have the max salary in that dept.

Then she asked me two puzzles:

1: <https://www.geeksforgeeks.org/aptitude/puzzle-mislabeled-jars/>

2: There is a lotus in a pond that grows double its size each day. On the nth day, it covers the entire pond. On which day will it cover 1/8 th the pond?

I knew the 1st puzzle as I had prepared the top 100 puzzles from GFG. But the 2nd one was new, but I tried to solve it on paper while explaining my approach. Then, when I could not explain, I asked for hint and then was able to solve it.

Then I was asked OOPs in JAVA. Where I was given the shapes, rectangle, square and rhombus, and to use oops concepts to depict their classes. So Shape was interface, rectangle and rhombus were abstract classes and square extended both rhombus and rectangle. Which led to the discussion on interfaces, abstract classes and the diamond problem in Java. The keyword super was also asked.

Then at last I was asked the DSA question of replacing a certain value from a linked list via in-place no using another linked list. I was told to write the code on paper.

Remember to be honest and think out your solutions loudly. If you do not know the answer, ask for hints; the interviewer is there to guide you.

5. HR Round: [15 students appeared] 2 panellists

Started with my family background, why CSE-AIML as a branch, where do you live, would travelling be easy? I was asked only about my academic scores — SSC, HSC, CET percentile, and CGPA.

Then came a question to explain my favourite project, to which I described my major project. Then they went deep by asking me in detail about this project. How I came up with the problem statement, the whole design of how it works, my role in it, as I did the ML part, they asked me about the data used, models used and the whole pipeline. Problems I faced while working on the project. They also asked the same questions about my other project. As my resume was inclined more towards ML and genai, they were concerned about my role in ISS, as they don't use much AI and ML in their projects. But I convinced them that to use mML models we need proper backed knowledge too, which I had in Flask and my basics were clear in the languages of Java and Python, so coding would not be a problem. They also asked how I keep myself updated with the latest technologies to which I answered I read news on the inshorts app. The interview ended when I asked the interviewers a question about my day as an intern at ISS

This round was a little more inclined towards my projects and my understanding of it. Very few Hr questions were asked.

Useful Tips:

[JAVA OOPS](#)

Top 100 puzzles from GFG

DSA from Strivers sheet

VERY IMPORTANT aptitude from Indiabix and its concepts from:

[LINK 1](#)

[LINK 2](#)

[DBMS](#)

Leetcode SQL 50

[Operating Systems](#)

All The Best!! Feel free to connect on [LinkedIn](#)

In case of any further doubts, you can refer to the past interview experiences shared by TPO.